

ing about: as games get more specialised, there is also specialised equipment that takes you beyond the keyboard and the mouse.

We aren't demeaning the mouse or the keyboard. The mouse still rules when it comes to point-and-click adventure games, or taking headshots in FPS. Different mice have different capabilities.

The very basic gaming equipment consists of four devices: mice, gamepads, joysticks, and racing wheels. Of these, the mouse is a device you can use for purposes other than gaming. The other devices are used only for gaming. Let's look at these devices one by one—we will look at devices, small and large, and also at some of the best that money can buy.

The Mouse

This unassuming little device has been around since the time the Apple Mac was introduced back in 1984: the GUI (Graphic User Interface) of its OS required a mouse to be used. There have since been a lot of mouse-related innovations, but mice remained in the trackball era for a long time. With the introduction of the optical mouse, a whole new world opened up for gamers. Wireless mice made more sense, too. However, there was one tiny drawback with optical mice: the light source used was an LED, and the precision offered by LEDs had its limitations. This, of course, means a lot for gamers.

Here's what Logitech has to say about the laser technology it debuted with its MX1X series of mice:

"Laser illumination reveals structure that an LED simply cannot express. The coherent



The Rotograf R2 Mark II gaming mouse